

Polyploid

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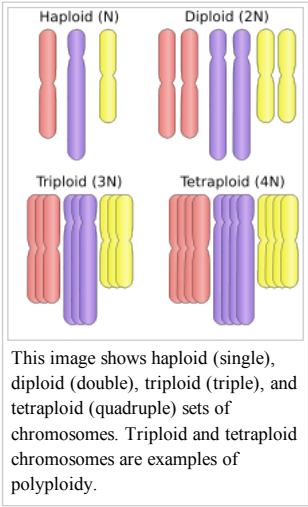
Polyploid cells and organisms are those containing more than two paired (homologous) sets of chromosomes. Most species whose cells have nuclei (Eukaryotes) are diploid, meaning they have two sets of chromosomes—one set inherited from each parent. However, **polyploidy** is found in some organisms and is especially common in plants. In addition, polyploidy occurs in some tissues of animals that are otherwise diploid, such as human muscle tissues.^[1] This is known as **endopolyploidy**. Species whose cells do not have nuclei, that is, Prokaryotes, may be polyploid organisms, as seen in the large bacterium *Epulopiscium fishelsoni* [1] (<http://m.pnas.org/content/105/18/6730.full>). Hence ploidy is defined with respect to a cell. Most eukaryotes have diploid somatic cells, but produce haploid gametes (eggs and sperm) by meiosis. A monoploid has only one set of chromosomes, and the term is usually only applied to cells or organisms that are normally diploid. Male bees and other Hymenoptera, for example, are monoploid. Unlike animals, plants and multicellular algae have life cycles with two alternating multicellular generations. The gametophyte generation is haploid, and produces gametes by mitosis, the sporophyte generation is diploid and produces spores by meiosis.

Polyploidy refers to a numerical change in a whole set of chromosomes. Organisms in which a particular chromosome, or chromosome segment, is under- or overrepresented are said to be aneuploid (from the Greek words meaning "not", "good", and "fold"). Therefore the distinction between aneuploidy and polyploidy is that aneuploidy refers to a numerical change in part of the chromosome set, whereas polyploidy refers to a numerical change in the whole set of chromosomes.^[2]

Polyploidy may occur due to abnormal cell division, either during mitosis, or commonly during metaphase I in meiosis.

Polyploidy occurs in some animals, such as goldfish,^[3] salmon, and salamanders, but is especially common among ferns and flowering plants (see *Hibiscus rosa-sinensis*), including both wild and cultivated species. Wheat, for example, after millennia of hybridization and modification by humans, has strains that are **diploid** (two sets of chromosomes), **tetraploid** (four sets of chromosomes) with the common name of durum or macaroni wheat, and **hexaploid** (six sets of chromosomes) with the common name of bread wheat. Many agriculturally important plants of the genus *Brassica* are also tetraploids.

Polyploidy can be induced in plants and cell cultures by some chemicals: the best known is colchicine, which can result in chromosome doubling, though its use may have other less obvious consequences as well. Oryzalin will also double the existing chromosome content.



Contents

- 1 Types
- 2 Animals
 - 2.1 Humans
- 3 Plants
 - 3.1 Crops
 - 3.1.1 Examples
- 4 Fungi
- 5 Chromalveolata
- 6 Terminology
 - 6.1 Autopolyploidy
 - 6.2 Allopolyploidy
 - 6.3 Paleopolyploidy
 - 6.4 Karyotype
 - 6.5 Paralogous
 - 6.6 Homologous
 - 6.7 Homoeologous
 - 6.7.1 Example of homoeologous chromosomes
- 7 Polyploidization and speciation
- 8 See also
- 9 References
- 10 Further reading
- 11 External links

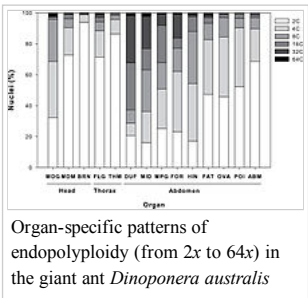
Types

Polyploid types are labeled according to the number of chromosome sets in the nucleus. The letter *x* is used to represent the number of chromosomes in a single set.

- triploid** (three sets; 3*x*), for example seedless watermelons, common in the phylum Tardigrada^[4]
- tetraploid** (four sets; 4*x*), for example Salmonidae fish,^[5] the cotton *Gossypium hirsutum* ^[6]
- pentaploid** (five sets; 5*x*), for example Kenai Birch (*Betula papyrifera* var. *kenaica*)
- hexaploid** (six sets; 6*x*), for example wheat, kiwifruit^[7]
- heptaploid** or **septaploid** (seven sets; 7*x*)
- octaploid** or **octoploid**, (eight sets; 8*x*), for example *Acipenser* (genus of sturgeon fish), dahlias
- decaploid** (ten sets; 10*x*), for example certain strawberries
- dodecaploid** (twelve sets; 12*x*), for example the plant *Celosia argentea* or the invasive one *Spartina anglica*^[8] or the amphibian *Xenopus ruwenzoriensis*.

Animals

Examples in animals are more common in non-vertebrates^[9] such as flatworms, leeches, and brine shrimp. Within vertebrates, examples of stable polyploidy include the salmonids and many cyprinids (i.e. carp).^[10] Some fish have as many as 400 chromosomes.^[10] Polyploidy also occurs commonly in amphibians; for example the biomedically-important *Xenopus* genus contains many different species with as many as 12 sets of chromosomes (dodecaploid).^[11] Polyploid lizards are also quite



common, but are sterile and must reproduce by parthenogenesis. Polyploid mole salamanders (mostly triploids) are all female and reproduce by kleptogenesis,^[12] "stealing" spermatophores from diploid males of related species to trigger egg development but not incorporating the males' DNA into the offspring. While mammalian liver cells are polyploid, rare instances of polyploid mammals are known, but most often result in prenatal death.

An octodontid rodent of Argentina's harsh desert regions, known as the Plains Viscacha-Rat (*Tympanoctomys barrerae*) has been reported as an exception to this 'rule'.^[13] However, careful analysis using chromosome paints shows that there are only two copies of each chromosome in *T. barrerae*, not the four expected if it were truly a tetraploid.^[14] The rodent is not a rat, but kin to guinea pigs and chinchillas. Its "new" diploid [2n] number is 102 and so its cells are roughly twice normal size. Its closest living relation is *Octomys mimax*, the Andean Viscacha-Rat of the same family, whose 2n = 56. It was therefore surmised that an *Octomys*-like ancestor produced tetraploid (i.e., 2n = 4x = 112) offspring that were, by virtue of their doubled chromosomes, reproductively isolated from their parents.

Polyploidy was induced in fish by Har Swarup (1956) using a cold-shock treatment of the eggs close to the time of fertilization, which produced triploid embryos that successfully matured.^{[15][16]} Cold or heat shock has also been shown to result in unreduced amphibian gametes, though this occurs more commonly in eggs than in sperm.^[17] John Gurdon (1958) transplanted intact nuclei from somatic cells to produce diploid eggs in the frog, *Xenopus* (an extension of the work of Briggs and King in 1952) that were able to develop to the tadpole stage.^[18] The British Scientist, J. B. S. Haldane hailed the work for its potential medical applications and, in describing the results, became one of the first to use the word "clone" in reference to animals. Later work by Shinya Yamanaka showed how mature cells can be reprogrammed to become pluripotent, extending the possibilities to non-stem cells. Gurdon and Yamanaka were jointly awarded the Nobel Prize in 2012 for this work.^[18]

Humans

True polyploidy rarely occurs in humans, although polyploid cells occur in highly differentiated tissue, such as liver parenchyma and heart muscle, and in bone marrow.^[19] Aneuploidy is more common.

Polyploidy occurs in humans in the form of triploidy, with 69 chromosomes (sometimes called 69,XXX), and tetraploidy with 92 chromosomes (sometimes called 92,XXXX). Triploidy, usually due to polyspermy, occurs in about 2–3% of all human pregnancies and ~15% of miscarriages. The vast majority of triploid conceptions end as a miscarriage; those that do survive to term typically die shortly after birth. In some cases, survival past birth may extend longer if there is mixoploidy with both a diploid and a triploid cell population present.

Triploidy may be the result of either digyny (the extra haploid set is from the mother) or diandry (the extra haploid set is from the father). Diandry is mostly caused by reduplication of the paternal haploid set from a single sperm, but may also be the consequence of dispermic (two sperm) fertilization of the egg.^[20] Digyny is most commonly caused by either failure of one meiotic division during oogenesis leading to a diploid oocyte or failure to extrude one polar body from the oocyte. Diandry appears to predominate among early miscarriages, while digyny predominates among triploidy that survives into the fetal period. However, among early miscarriages, digyny is also more common in those cases <8.5 weeks gestational age or those in which an embryo is present. There are also two distinct phenotypes in triploid placentas and fetuses that are dependent on the origin of the extra haploid set. In digyny, there is typically an asymmetric poorly grown fetus, with marked adrenal hypoplasia and a very small placenta. In diandry, a partial hydatidiform mole develops.^[20] These parent-of-origin effects reflect the effects of genomic imprinting.

Complete tetraploidy is more rarely diagnosed than triploidy, but is observed in 1–2% of early miscarriages. However, some tetraploid cells are commonly found in chromosome analysis at prenatal diagnosis and these are generally considered 'harmless'. It is not clear whether these tetraploid cells simply tend to arise during *in vitro* cell culture or whether they are also present in placental cells *in vivo*. There are, at any rate, very few clinical reports of fetuses/infants diagnosed with tetraploidy mosaicism.

Mixoploidy is quite commonly observed in human preimplantation embryos and includes haploid/diploid as well as diploid/tetraploid mixed cell populations. It is unknown whether these embryos fail to implant and are therefore rarely detected in ongoing pregnancies or if there is simply a selective process favoring the diploid cells.

Plants

Polyploidy is pervasive in plants and some estimates suggest that 30–80% of living plant species are polyploid, and many lineages show evidence of ancient polyploidy (paleopolyploidy) in their genomes.^{[21][22][23]} Huge explosions in angiosperm species diversity appear to have coincided with the timing of ancient genome duplications shared by many species.^[24] It has been established that 15% of angiosperm and 31% of fern speciation events are accompanied by ploidy increase.^[25]

Polyploid plants can arise spontaneously in nature by several mechanisms, including meiotic or mitotic failures, and fusion of unreduced (2n) gametes.^[26] Both autopolyploids (e.g. potato^[27]) and allopolyploids (e.g. canola, wheat, cotton) can be found among both wild and domesticated plant species.

Most polyploids display novel variation or morphologies relative to their parental species, that may contribute to the processes of speciation and eco-niche exploitation.^{[22][26]} The mechanisms leading to novel variation in newly formed allopolyploids may include gene dosage effects (resulting from more numerous copies of genome content), the reunion of divergent gene regulatory hierarchies, chromosomal rearrangements, and epigenetic remodeling, all of which affect gene content and/or expression levels.^{[28][29][30][31]} Many of these rapid changes may contribute to reproductive isolation and speciation. However seed generated from interploidy crosses, such as between polyploids and their parent species, usually suffer from aberrant endosperm development which impairs their viability,^{[32][33]} thus contributing to polyploid speciation.

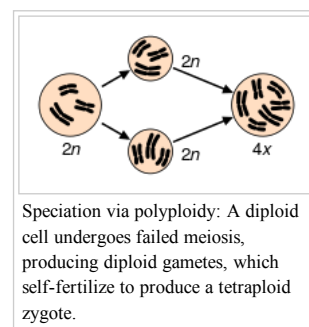
Lomatia tasmanica is an extremely rare Tasmanian shrub that is triploid and sterile; reproduction is entirely vegetative, with all plants having the same genetic constitution.

There are few naturally occurring polyploid conifers. One example is the Coast Redwood *Sequoia sempervirens*, which is a hexaploid (6x) with 66 chromosomes (2n = 6x = 66), although the origin is unclear.^[34]

Aquatic plants, especially the Monocotyledons, include a large number of polyploids.^[35]

Crops

The induction of polyploidy is a common technique to overcome the sterility of a hybrid species during plant breeding. For example, Triticale is the hybrid of wheat (*Triticum turgidum*) and rye (*Secale cereale*). It combines sought-after characteristics of the parents, but the initial hybrids are sterile. After polyploidization, the hybrid becomes fertile and can thus be further propagated to become triticale.



In some situations, polyploid crops are preferred because they are sterile. For example, many seedless fruit varieties are seedless as a result of polyploidy. Such crops are propagated using asexual techniques, such as grafting.

Polyploidy in crop plants is most commonly induced by treating seeds with the chemical colchicine.

Examples

- Triploid crops: apple, banana, citrus, ginger, watermelon^[36]
- Tetraploid crops: apple, durum or macaroni wheat, cotton, potato, canola/rapeseed, leek, tobacco, peanut, kinnow, Pelargonium
- Hexaploid crops: chrysanthemum, bread wheat, triticale, oat, kiwifruit^[7]
- Octaploid crops: strawberry, dahlia, pansies, sugar cane, oca (*Oxalis tuberosa*)^[37]
- Dodecaploid crops: some sugar cane hybrids ^[38]

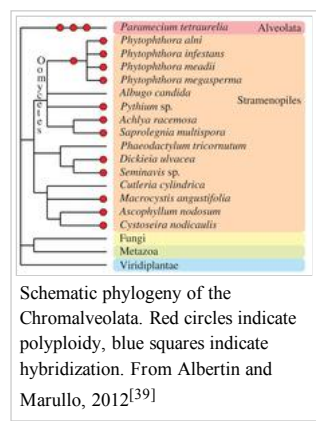
Some crops are found in a variety of ploidies: tulips and lilies are commonly found as both diploid and triploid; daylilies (*Hemerocallis* cultivars) are available as either diploid or tetraploid; apples and kinnows can be diploid, triploid, or tetraploid.

Fungi

Besides plants and animals, the evolutionary history of various fungal species is dotted by past and recent whole-genome duplication events (see Albertin and Marullo 2012^[39] for review). Several examples of polyploids are known:

- autopolyploid: the aquatic fungi of genus *Allomyces*,^[40] some *Saccharomyces cerevisiae* strains used in bakery,^[41] etc.
- allopolyploid: the widespread *Cyathus stercoreus*,^[42] the allotetraploid lager yeast *Saccharomyces pastorianus*,^[43] the allotriploid wine spoilage yeast *Dekkera bruxellensis*,^[44] etc.
- paleopolyploid: the human pathogen *Rhizopus oryzae*,^[45] the *Saccharomyces* genus,^[46] etc.

In addition, polyploidy is frequently associated with hybridization and reticulate evolution that appear to be highly prevalent in several fungal taxa. Indeed, homoploid speciation (*i.e.*, hybrid speciation without a change in chromosome number) has been evidenced for some fungal species (*e.g.*, the basidiomycota *Microbotryum violaceum* ^[47]).



Schematic phylogeny of the Chromalveolata. Red circles indicate polyploidy, blue squares indicate hybridization. From Albertin and Marullo, 2012^[39]

As for plants and animals, fungal hybrids and polyploids display structural and functional modifications compared to their progenitors and diploid counterparts. In particular, the structural and functional outcomes of polyploid *Saccharomyces* genomes strikingly reflect the evolutionary fate of plant polyploid ones. Large chromosomal rearrangements^[48] leading to chimeric chromosomes^[49] have been described, as well as more punctual genetic modifications such as gene loss.^[50] The homoealleles of the allotetraploid yeast *S. pastorianus* show unequal contribution to the transcriptome.^[51] Phenotypic diversification is also observed following polyploidization and/or hybridization in fungi,^[52] producing the fuel for natural selection and subsequent adaptation and speciation.

Chromalveolata

Other eukaryotic taxa have experienced one or more polyploidization events during their evolutionary history (see Albertin and Marullo, 2012^[39] for review). The oomycetes, which are non-true fungi members, contain several examples of paleopolyploid and polyploid species, such as within the *Phytophthora* genus.^[53] Some species of brown algae (Fucales, Laminariales ^[54] and diatoms ^[55]) contain apparent polyploid genomes. In the Alveolata group, the remarkable species *Paramecium tetraurelia* underwent three successive rounds of whole-genome duplication ^[56] and established itself as a major model for paleopolyploid studies.

Terminology

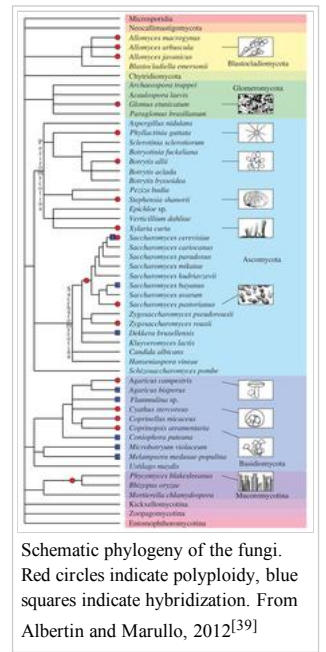
Autopolyploidy

Autopolyploids are polyploids with multiple chromosome sets derived from a single species. Autopolyploids can arise from a spontaneous, naturally occurring genome doubling, like the potato.^[27] Others might form following fusion of 2n gametes (unreduced gametes). Bananas and apples can be found as autotriploids. Autopolyploid plants typically display polysomic inheritance, and therefore have low fertility, but may be propagated clonally.

Allopolyploidy

Allopolyploids are polyploids with chromosomes derived from different species. Precisely it is the result of multiplying the chromosome number in an F1 hybrid. *Triticale* is an example of an allopolyploid, having six chromosome sets, allohexaploid, four from wheat (*Triticum turgidum*) and two from rye (*Secale cereale*). *Amphidiploids* are a type of allopolyploids (they are tetraploid, containing the diploid chromosome sets of both parents^[57]). Some of the best examples of allopolyploids come from the Brassicas, and the Triangle of U describes the relationships between the three common diploid Brassicas (*B. oleracea*, *B. rapa*, and *B. nigra*) and three allotetraploids (*B. napus*, *B. juncea*, and *B. carinata*) derived from hybridization among the diploids.

Species	Common Name	Family	Hybridization	Confirmed or Putative Hybridization?	Putative Parental/Introgressive species	Polyploid or Homoploid?	Polyploid Chromosome Count	Reference:
Abelmoschus esculentus (L.) Moench	Okra	Malvaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Putative	Uncertain	Polyploid (tetraploid)	usually 2n=4x=130	Joshi and Ha 1956; Schafleitner al., 2013
Actinidia deliciosa (A. Chev.) C.F.Liang & A.R.Ferguson	Kiwifruit	Actinidiaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Putative	Actinidia chinensis Planch. and Unknown	Polyploid (hexaploid)	2n=6x=174	Atkinson et al. 1997



Schematic phylogeny of the fungi. Red circles indicate polyploidy, blue squares indicate hybridization. From Albertin and Marullo, 2012^[39]

Agave fourcroydes Lem.	Henequen	Asparagaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	Uncertain	Polyploid (usu. pentaploid, triploid)	2n=5x(3x)=150(90)	Robert et al., 2008; Hughe al., 2007
Agave sisalana Perrine	Sisal	Asparagaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	Uncertain	Polyploid (usu. pentaploid, hexaploid)	2n=5x(6x)=150(180)	Robert et al., 2008
Allium ampeloprasum L.	Great headed garlic	Amaryllidaceae	Intraspecific hybrid origin	Putative	Allium ampeloprasum L.	Homoploid	-	Guenauoui et 2013
Allium cepa L.	Common onion	Amaryllidaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Putative	Uncertain: Allium vavilovii Popov & Vved., A. galanthum Kar. & Kir. or A. fistulosum L.	Homoploid	-	Gurushidze et 2007
Allium cornutum Clementi	Triploid onion	Amaryllidaceae	Triparental allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	Allium cepa L., A. roylei Stearn, unknown	Polyploid (triploid)	2n=3x=24	Fredotovic et 2014
Ananas comosus (L.) Merr is	Pineapple	Bromeliaceae	Interspecific introgression	Putative	Ananas ananassoides (Baker) L.B. Smith	Homoploid	-	Duval et al.,
Annona x atemoya	Atemoya	Annonaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Confirmed	Annona cherimola Mill. and A. squamosa L.	?	-	Perfectti et a 2004; Jalikoj 2010
Arachis hypogaea L.	Peanut	Fabaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	Arachis duranensis Krapov. & W.C. Greg. and A. ipaënsis Krapov. & W.C. Greg.	Polypoid (tetraploid)	2n=4x=40	Kochert et al 1996; Bertio al., 2011
Armoracia rusticana P.Gaertn., B.Mey. & Scherb.	Horseradish	Brassicaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Putative	Uncertain	?	-	Courter and Rhodes, 1969
Artocarpus altilis (Parkinson ex F.A.Zorn) Fosberg	Breadfruit	Moraceae	Interspecific introgression	Putative	Artocarpus mariannensis Trécul	?	-	Zerega et al., 2005; Jones et al., 2013
Avena sativa L.	Oat	Poaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	Uncertain	Polyploid (hexaploid)	2n=6x=42	Linares et al. 1998; Oliver al., 2013
Brassica carinata A.Braun	Ethiopian mustard	Brassicaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	Brassica oleracea L. and B. nigra (L.) K.Koch	Polyploid (tetraploid)	2n=4x=19	Arias et al., 2012
Brassica juncea (L.) Czern.	Indian mustard	Brassicaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	Brassica nigra (L.) K.Koch and B. rapa L.	Polyploid (tetraploid)	2n=4x=18	Arias et al., 2012
Brassica napus L.	Rapeseed, Rutabega	Brassicaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	Brassica rapa L. and B. oleracea L.	Polyploid (tetraploid)	2n=4x=19	Arias et al., 2012
Cajanus cajan (L.) Millsp.	Pigeon Pea	Fabaceae	Intraspecific introgression, interspecific introgression	Putative	Wild Cajanus cajan and other species	Homoploid	-	Kassa et al.,
Cannabis sativa L.	Hemp	Cannabaceae	Intraspecific introgression	Putative	Cannabis sativa L. 'Indica' and 'Sativa' types	Homoploid	-	de Meijer an van Soest, 1999
Carica pentagona Heilborn	Babaco	Caricaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Confirmed	Uncertain (Carica stipulata V.M.Badillo, Vasconcellea pubescens A.DC., Vasconcellea weberbaueri (Harms) V.M. Badillo)	?	-	Van Droogenbroe et al., 2002; ' Droogenbroe et al., 2006
Carya illinoensis (Wangenh.) K.Koch	Pecan	Juglandaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Putative	Uncertain	?	-	Grauke et al. 2011
Castanea dentata (Marshall) Borkh	Chestnut	Fagaceae	Interspecific introgression	Confirmed	Castanea pumila (L.) Mill.	Homoploid	-	Li and Dane, 2013
Castanea	Chestnut	Fagaceae	Intraspecific	Confirmed	Castanea sativa Eurosiberian and	Homoploid		Villani et al., 1999; Mattio

<i>Cassia sativa</i> Mill.	Chickpea	Fabaceae	Intraspecific introgression	Confirmed	Lebanese and Mediterranean populations	Homoploid	-	1999; Mader et al., 2013
<i>Chenopodium quinoa</i> Willd.	Quinoa	Chenopodiaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Putative	Uncertain	Polyploid (tetraploid)	-	Heiser, 1974; Ward, 2000; Maughan et al., 2004
<i>Cicer arietinum</i> L.	Chickpea (pea-shaped)	Fabaceae	Intraspecific hybrid origin	Putative	<i>Cicer arietinum</i> L. Desi and Kabuli Germplasm	?	-	Upadhyaya et al., 2008; Kenen et al., 2011
<i>Cichorium intybus</i> L.	Radicchio	Asteraceae	Interspecific introgression	Confirmed	Wild <i>Cichorium intybus</i> L.	Homoploid	-	Kiaer et al., 2012
<i>Citrus aurantiifolia</i> (Christm.) Swingle	Key lime	Rutaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Confirmed	<i>Citrus medica</i> L. and <i>C. subg. Papeda</i>	?	-	Ollitrault and Navarro, 2011; Penjor et al., 2014; Nicolini et al., 2000; Moore, 2001
<i>Citrus aurantium</i> L.	Sour oranges	Rutaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Confirmed	<i>Citrus maxima</i> (Burm.) and <i>C. reticulata</i> Blanco	?	-	Wu et al., 2001; Moore, 2001
<i>Citrus clementina</i> hort.	Clementine	Rutaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Confirmed	<i>Citrus sinensis</i> (L.) Osbeck and <i>C. reticulata</i> Blanco	?	-	Wu et al., 2001
<i>Citrus limon</i> (L.) Osbeck	Lemon, lime	Rutaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Confirmed	<i>Citrus medica</i> L., <i>C. aurantiifolia</i> (Christm.) Swingle, and uncertain	?	-	Nicolosi et al., 2000; Moore, 2001
<i>Citrus paradisi</i> Macfad.	Grapefruit	Rutaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Confirmed	<i>Citrus sinensis</i> (L.) Osbeck and <i>C. maxima</i> (Burm.)	?	-	Wu et al., 2001; Moore, 2001
<i>Citrus reticulata</i> Blanco	Mandarin	Rutaceae	Interspecific introgression	Confirmed	<i>Citrus maxima</i> (Burm.)	?	-	Wu et al., 2001
<i>Citrus sinensis</i> (L.) Osbeck	Sweet orange (blood, common)	Rutaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Confirmed	Uncertain	?	-	Wu et al., 2001; Moore, 2001
<i>Cocos nucifera</i> L.	Coconut	Arecaceae	Intraspecific introgression	Confirmed	<i>Cocos nucifera</i> L. Indo-Atlantic and Pacific lineages	Homoploid	-	Gunn et al., 2012
<i>Coffea arabica</i> L.	Coffee	Rubiaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	<i>Coffea eugenioides</i> S.Moore and <i>C. canephora</i> Pierre ex A.Froehner	Polyploid (tetraploid)	2n=4x=44	Lashermes et al., 1999
<i>Corylus avellana</i> L.	Hazelnut	Betulaceae	Intraspecific introgression	Confirmed	Wild <i>Corylus avellana</i> L. in Southern Europe	Homoploid	-	Campa et al., 2011; Boccardo et al., 2013
<i>Cucurbita pepo</i> L.	Winter Squash, Pumpkin	Cucurbitaceae	Intraspecific introgression	Putative	<i>Cucurbita pepo</i> var. <i>texana</i> (Scheele) D.S.Decker	Homoploid	-	Kirkpatrick et al., 1988; Wilson, 1988
<i>Daucus carota</i> subsp. <i>sativus</i> (Hoffm.) Arcang.	Carrot	Apiaceae	Intraspecific introgression	Confirmed	<i>Daucus carota</i> L. subsp. <i>carota</i>	Homoploid	-	Iorizzo et al., 2013; Simon, 2000
<i>Dioscorea</i> L. spp.	Yam	Dioscoreaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin, introgression	Putative	Uncertain	Variable	-	Terauchi et al., 1992; Dansi et al., 1999; Bhattacharjee et al., 2011; Mignouna et al., 2002
<i>Diospyros kaki</i> L.f.	Persimmon	Ebenaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Putative	Uncertain	Polyploid (hexaploid)	Yonemori et al., 2008	
<i>Ficus carica</i> L.	Fig	Moraceae	Interspecific introgression	Putative	Uncertain	?	- Aradhya et al., 2010	
<i>Fragaria ananassa</i> (Duchesne ex Weston) Duchesne ex Rozier	Strawberries	Rosaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Confirmed	<i>Fragaria virginiana</i> Mill. (octoploid), <i>F. chiloensis</i> (L.) Mill. (octoploid)	Homoploid relative to parentals (octoploid)	2n=8x=56 Evans, 1977; Hirakawa et al., 2014	Uncertain w/ species form the octoploid progenitors

Garcinia mangostana L.	Mangosteen	Clusiaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Putative	Garcinia celebica L. and G. malaccensis Hook.f. ex T.Anderson	Polyploid (tetraploid)	? Richards, 1990	Recent work shows this may not be of hybrid origin (Nazroun et al., 2014)
Gossypium hirsutum L.	Upland Cotton	Malvaceae	hybrid origin	Confirmed	Uncertain, referred to as 'A' and 'D'	Polyploid (formed <1MYA)	2n = 4x = 52 Wendel and Cronn 2003	Polyploidization likely led to agronomically significant traits (Applequist et al., 2001)
Hibiscus sabdariffa L.	Roselle	Malvaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Putative	Uncertain	Polyploid (tetraploid)	2n = 4x = 72 Menzel and Wilson, 1966; Satya et al., 2013	
Hordeum vulgare L.	Barley	Poaceae	Introgression	Confirmed	Hordeum spontaneum K.Koch	Homoploid	- Badr et al., 2000; Dai et al., 2012	
Humulus lupulus L.	Hops	Cannabaceae	Intraspecific introgression	Confirmed	Humulus lupulus L. North American and European Germplasm	Homoploid	- Reeves and Richards, 2011; Stajner et al., 2008; Seefelder et al., 2000	
Ipomoea batatas (L.) Lam.	Sweet Potato	Convolvulaceae	Intraspecific introgression; Interspecific introgression?	Putative	Ipomoea batatas (L.) Lam. Central American and South American Germplasm	Homoploid relative to parentals	Roullier et al., 2013	
Juglans regia L.	Walnut	Juglandaceae	Interspecific hybridization	Confirmed	Juglans sigillata Dode	Homoploid	- Gunn et al., 2010	
Lactuca sativa L.	Lettuce	Asteraceae	Intraspecific hybrid origin	Putative	Lactuca serriola L. and other L. spp.	Homoploid	- de Vries, 1997	
Lagenaria siceraria (Molina) Standl.	Bottle Gourd	Cucurbitaceae	Intraspecific introgression	Confirmed	Lagenaria siceraria (Molina) Standl. African/American and Asian Germplasm	Homoploid	- Clarke et al., 2006	
Lens culinaris Medik. ssp. culinaris	Lentil	Fabaceae	Intraspecific introgression	Putative	Wild lentil, Lens culinaris subsp. orientalis (Boiss.) Ponert	Homoploid	- Erskine et al., 2011	
Macadamia integrifolia Maiden & Betche	Macadamia	Proteaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin, interspecific introgression	Confirmed	Macadamia tetraphylla L.A.S.Johnson, and other M. spp.	Homoploid	- Hardner et al., 2009; Steiger et al., 2003; Aradhya et al., 1998	
Malus domestica Borkh.	Apple	Rosaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Confirmed	Malus sieversii (Ledeb.) M.Roem., M. sylvestris (L.) Mill., and possibly others	Homoploid	- Cornille et al., 2012	
Mentha piperita L.	Peppermint	Lamiaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	Mentha aquatica L. and M. spicata L.	Polyploid (12-ploid)	2n = 12x = 66 or 72 Harley and Brighton, 1977; Gobert et al., 2002	
Musa paradisiaca L.	Banana	Musaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	Musa acuminata Colla, M. balbisiana Colla	Polyploid (usually triploid)	2n = 3x = 33 Simmonds and Shepherd, 1955; Heslop-Harrison and Schwarzhacher, 2007; De Langhe et al., 2010	
Nicotiana tabacum L.	Tobacco	Solanaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	Uncertain (Nicotiana sylvestris Speg. & S. Comes and N. tomentosiformis Goodsp.)	Polyploid (tetraploid)	2n = 4x = 48 Kenton et al., 1993; Murad et al., 2002	
Olea europaea L.	Olive	Oleaceae	Intraspecific introgression	Putative	Wild Olea europaea L., Eastern and Western Germplasm	Homoploid	- Kaniewski et al., 2012; Besnard et al., 2013; Breton et al., 2006; Rubio de Casas et al., 2006; Besnard et al., 2007; Besnard et al., 2000	
Opuntia L. spp.	Opuntia	Cactaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin, Allopolyploid origin	Putative	Including Opuntia ficus-indica (L.) Mill.	Polyploid, homoploid	- Hughes et al., 2007; Griffith, 2004	
Oryza sativa L.	Rice	Poaceae	Intraspecific introgression, interspecific introgression	Putative	Oryza sativa L. 'Japonica' and 'Indica' Germplasm, Oryza rufipogon Griff.	Homoploid	- Caicedo et al., 2007; Gao and Innan, 2008	
Oxalis tuberosa Molina	Oca	Oxalidaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Putative	Uncertain	Polyploid (octaploid)	2n = 8x = 64 Emswiler and Doyle, 2002; Emswiler 2002; Emswiler et al., 2009	

Pennisetum glaucum (L.) R.Br.	Pearl Millet	Poaceae	Intraspecific introgression	Confirmed	Wild Pennisetum glaucum (L.) R.Br.	Homoploid	- Oumar et al., 2008	
Persea americana Mill.	Avocado (Hass and other cultivars)	Lauraceae	Intraspecific introgression	Confirmed	Persea americana Mill. 'Guatemalensis', 'Drymifolia', and 'Americana'	Homoploid	- Chen et al., 2008; Davis et al., 1998; Ashworth and Clegg, 2003; Douhan et al., 2011	
Phoenix dactylifera L.	Date palm	Arecaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Putative	Uncertain	Homoploid	- El Hadrami et al., 2011; Bennaceur et al., 1991	
Piper methysticum G.Forst.	Kava	Piperaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Putative	Piper wichmannii C. DC. and P. gibbiflorum C.DC.	Polyploid (decaploid)	2n=10x=130 Singh, 2004; Lebot et al., 1991	
Pistacia vera L.	Pistachio	Anacardiaceae	Interspecific introgression	Putative	Pistacia atlantica Desf., P. chinensis subsp. integerrima (J. L. Stewart ex Brandis) Rech. f.	Homoploid	- Kafkas et al., 2001	
Pisum abyssinicum A.Braun	Pea	Fabaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Confirmed	Uncertain (Pisum fulvum Sibth. & Sm. and other P. spp.)	Homoploid	- Vershinin et al., 2003	
Pisum sativum L.	Pea	Fabaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Confirmed	Uncertain (Pisum sativum subsp. elatius (M.Bieb.) Asch. & Graebn. and other P. spp.)	Homoploid	- Vershinin et al., 2003	
Plinia cauliflora (Mart.) Kausel	Jaboticaba	Myrtaceae	Intraspecific hybridization, interspecific hybridization	Putative	Plinia 'Jaboticaba' and 'Cauliflora' Germplasm; P. peruviana (Poir.) Govaerts	Homoploid	- Balerdi et al., 2006	
Prunus cerasus L.	Cherry	Rosaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	Prunus avium (L.) L. and P. fruticosa Pall.	Polyploid (tetraploid)	2n=4x=32 Tavaud et al., 2004; Olden and Nybom, 1968	
Prunus domestica L.	Plum	Rosaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	Uncertain (P. cerasifera Ehrh. and P. spinosa L.)	Polyploid (hexaploid)	2n=6x=48 Zohary, 1992; Hartmann and Neumuller, 2009	Japanese Plum also of hybrid origin (see Hartmann and Neumuller 2009) Also hybridized with other cultivated Pr spp.
Prunus dulcis (Mill.) D.A.Webb	Almond	Rosaceae	Interspecific introgression	Confirmed	Prunus orientalis (Mill.) Koehne and other P. spp.	Homoploid	- Delplancke et al., 2012; Delplancke et al., 2013	
Pyrus L. species	Pear	Rosaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Confirmed	Many species	Homoploid	- Silva et al., 2014	Also introgression with semidomestic populations (Iketani et al. 2009)
Raphanus raphanistrum subsp. sativus (L.) Domin	Radish	Brassicaceae	Intraspecific introgression	Confirmed	Raphanus raphanistrum L. subsp. raphanistrum	Homoploid	- Ridley et al., 2008	
Rheum L. cultivated species	Rhubarb	Polygonaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Putative	Unclear	Homoploid relative to parentals (tetraploid)	- Foust and Marshall, 1991; Kuhl and Deboer, 2008	Hybrids incl Rheum rhaponticum R. rhabarbarum L., R. palmatum L.
Rubus L. spp.	Red raspberry, Blackberry, Tayberry, Boysenberry, etc.	Rosaceae	Allopolyploid origin, interspecific hybridization	Confirmed	Many	Polyploid	- Alice et al., 2014; Alice and Campbell, 1999	
Saccharum spp.	Sugarcane	Poaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	Saccharum officinarum L. and S. spontaneum L.	Polyploid	Variable, 2n=10-13x=100-130 Grivet et al., 1995; D'Hont et al., 1996	
Secale cereale L.	Rye	Poaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin	Confirmed	Uncertain (Secale montanum Guss., S. vavilovii Grossh.)	Homoploid	- Bartos et al., 2008; Korzun et al., 2001; Hillman, 1978; Tang et al., 2011; Salamini et al., 2002	
Sechium edule (Jacq.) Sw.	Chayote	Cucurbitaceae	Interspecific introgression	Putative	Sechium compositum (Donn. Sm.) C. Jeffrey	Homoploid	- Newstrom, 1991	
Setaria italica	Foxtail		Interspecific		Setaria viridis (L.)		- Till-Bottraud et al.	

7/25/2015

Polyloid - Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia

<i>Solanum tuberosum</i> (L.) P.Beauv.	Common potato	Poaceae	Interspecific introgression	Confirmed	<i>Solanum tuberosum</i> (L.) P.Beauv.	Homoploid	- The-Dorville et al., 1992	
<i>Solanum L. spp.</i> Section Petota	Potato	Solanaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin, allopolyploid origin, interspecific introgression	Confirmed	Including <i>Solanum tuberosum</i> L., <i>S. ajanhuiri</i> Juz. & Bukasov, <i>S. curtilobum</i> Juz. & Bukasov, <i>S. juzepczukii</i> Bukasov	Homoploid and Polyploid	- Rodriguez et al., 2010	
<i>Solanum lycopersicum</i> L.	Tomato	Solanaceae	Intraspecific introgression, interspecific introgression	Confirmed	<i>Solanum lycopersicum</i> var. <i>cerasiforme</i> (Dunal) D.M. Spooner, G.J. Anderson & R.K. Jansen and <i>S. pimpinellifolium</i> L.	Homoploid	- Blanca et al., 2012; Causse et al., 2013; Rick, 1950	
<i>Solanum melongena</i> L.	Eggplant	Solanaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin, interspecific introgression, intraspecific introgression	Confirmed	<i>Solanum undatum</i> Lam. and others; wild <i>S. melongena</i> L. (= <i>S. insanum</i> L.)	Homoploid	- Knapp et al., 2013; Meyer et al., 2012	Hybrid origin not confirmed but introgression is well documented
<i>Solanum muricatum</i> Aiton	Pepino dulce	Solanaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin, interspecific introgression	Likely	<i>Solanum</i> species in Series <i>Caripensia</i>	Homoploid	- Blanca et al., 2007	Polyphyletic origin and extensive, ongoing introgression with wild species
<i>Spondias purpurea</i> L.	Jocote	Anacardiaceae	Interspecific introgression	Putative	<i>Spondias mombin</i> L.	Homoploid	- Miller and Schaal, 2005	
<i>Theobroma cacao</i> L.	Cacao (Trinitario-type)	Malvaceae	Intraspecific hybrid origin	Confirmed	<i>Theobroma cacao</i> L. 'Forastero' and 'Criollo' Germplasm	Homoploid	- Yang et al., 2013	
<i>Triticum aestivum</i> L.	Bread Wheat, Spelt	Poaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	<i>Triticum turgidum</i> L. (tetraploid) with <i>Aegilops tauschii</i> Coss.	Polyploid (hexaploid)	2n=6x=42 Matsuoka, 2011; Dvorak, 2012	
<i>Triticum turgidum</i> L.	Emmer Wheat, Durum Wheat	Poaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	<i>Triticum urartu</i> Thumanjan ex Gandilyan and <i>Aegilops speltoides</i> Tausch	Polyploid (tetraploid)	2n=4x=28 Dvorak et al., 2012; Matsuoka, 2011; Yamane and Kawahara, 2005	
<i>Vaccinium corymbosum</i> L.	Highbush Blueberry	Ericaceae	Interspecific hybrid origin, interspecific introgression	Putative	<i>Vaccinium tenellum</i> Aiton, <i>V. darrowii</i> Camp, (<i>V. virgatum</i> Aiton, <i>V. angustifolium</i> Aiton)	Uncertain	- Vander Kloet, 1980; Bruederle et al., 1994; Lyrene et al., 2003; Boches et al., 2006	Possible hybrid origin during Plesitocene
<i>Vanilla tahitensis</i> J.W. Moore	Tahitian vanilla	Orchidaceae	Allopolyploid origin	Confirmed	<i>Vanilla planifolia</i> Jacks. ex Andrews and <i>V. odorata</i> C.Presl	Polyploid	Variable, 2n=2x(4x)=32(64) Lubinsky et al., 2008	
<i>Vitis rotundifolia</i> Michx.	Grape	Vitaceae	Interspecific introgression	Confirmed	Many <i>Vitis</i> spp.	Homoploid	2n=2x=38 Reisch et al., 2012; This et al., 2006	
<i>Zea mays</i> L.	Maize	Poaceae	Intraspecific introgression	Confirmed	Wild <i>Zea mays</i> L. (teosinte, =subsp. <i>parviglumis</i> Iltis & Doebley)	Homoploid	- Van Heerwaarden et al., 2011; Hufford et al., 2013	

[58]

Paleopolyploidy

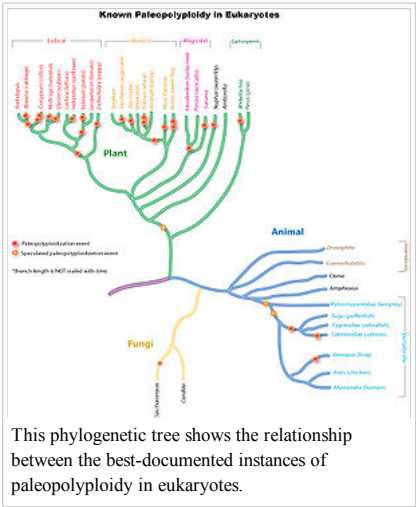
Ancient genome duplications probably occurred in the evolutionary history of all life. Duplication events that occurred long ago in the history of various evolutionary lineages can be difficult to detect because of subsequent diploidization (such that a polyploid starts to behave cytogenetically as a diploid over time) as mutations and gene translations gradually make one copy of each chromosome unlike the other copy. Over time, it is also common for duplicated copies of genes to accumulate mutations and become inactive pseudogenes.^[59]

In many cases, these events can be inferred only through comparing sequenced genomes. Examples of unexpected but recently confirmed ancient genome duplications include baker's yeast (*Saccharomyces cerevisiae*), mustard weed/thale cress (*Arabidopsis thaliana*), rice (*Oryza sativa*), and an early evolutionary ancestor of the vertebrates (which includes the human lineage) and another near the origin of the teleost fishes. Angiosperms (flowering plants) have paleopolyploidy in their ancestry. All eukaryotes probably have experienced a polyploidy event at some point in their evolutionary history.

Karyotype

A karyotype is the characteristic chromosome complement of a eukaryote species.^{[60][61]} The preparation and study of karyotypes is part of cytology and, more specifically, cytogenetics.

Although the replication and transcription of DNA is highly standardized in eukaryotes, the same cannot be said for their karyotypes, which are highly variable between species in chromosome number and in detailed organization despite being constructed out of the same macromolecules. In some cases, there is even significant variation within species. This variation provides the basis for a range of studies in what might be called evolutionary cytology.



This phylogenetic tree shows the relationship between the best-documented instances of paleopolyploidy in eukaryotes.

Paralogous

The term is used to describe the relationship between duplicated genes or portions of chromosomes that derived from a common ancestral DNA. Paralogous segments of DNA may arise spontaneously by errors during DNA replication, copy and paste transposons, or whole genome duplications.

Homologous

The term is used to describe the relationship of similar chromosomes that pair at mitosis and meiosis. In a diploid, one homolog is derived from the male parent (sperm) and one is derived from the female parent (egg). During meiosis and gametogenesis, homologous chromosomes pair and exchange genetic material by recombination, leading to the production of sperm or eggs with chromosome haplotypes containing novel genetic variation.

Homoeologous

The term *homoeologous*, also spelled *homeologous*, is used to describe the relationship of similar chromosomes or parts of chromosomes brought together following inter-species hybridization and allopolyploidization, and whose relationship was completely homologous in an ancestral species. In allopolyploids, the homologous chromosomes within each parental sub-genome should pair faithfully during meiosis, leading to disomic inheritance; however in some allopolyploids, the homoeologous chromosomes of the parental genomes may be nearly as similar to one another as the homologous chromosomes, leading to tetrasomic inheritance (four chromosomes pairing at meiosis), intergenomic recombination, and reduced fertility.

Example of homoeologous chromosomes

Durum wheat is the result of the inter-species hybridization of two diploid grass species *Triticum urartu* and *Aegilops speltoides*. Both diploid ancestors had two sets of 7 chromosomes, which were similar in terms of size and genes contained on them. Durum wheat contains two sets of chromosomes derived from *Triticum urartu* and two sets of chromosomes derived from *Aegilops speltoides*. Each chromosome pair derived from the *Triticum urartu* parent is **homoeologous** to the opposite chromosome pair derived from the *Aegilops speltoides* parent, though each chromosome pair unto itself is **homologous**.

Polyloidization and speciation

Polyloidization is a mechanism of sympatric speciation because polyploids are usually unable to interbreed with their diploid ancestors. An example is the plant *Mimulus peregrinus*. Sequencing confirmed that this species originated from *M. x robertsii*, a sterile triploid hybrid between *M. guttatus* and *M. luteus*, both of which have been introduced and naturalised in the United Kingdom. New populations of *M. peregrinus* arose on the Scottish mainland and the Orkney Islands via genome duplication from local populations of *M. x robertsii*.^[62]

See also

- Polyploid complex
- Polysomy
- Sympatry

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- Polyploidy on Kimball's Biology Pages (http://users.rcn.com/jkimball.ma.ultranet/BiologyPages/P/Polyploidy.html)
- The polyploidy portal (http://www.polyploidy.org/) a community-editable project with information, research, education, and a bibliography about polyploidy.

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